

Four new companies join OpenTAP project for open source test automation

Keysight Technologies has announced the addition of four new participants to the OpenTAP project for open source test automation, which it launched with Nokia in May 2019.

The project comprises a growing community of developers dedicated to the idea of effortless automation.

The core of OpenTAP is a test sequencer, with the community continuously adding plugins and solutions that support faster development, new functionality and optimisation in testing. Due to these contributions and the enhanced collaboration possible with its open-core approach, OpenTAP is inspiring developers to innovate automation solutions in testing and measurement, and beyond.

The four new participants are 5G-VINNI, Page Electronica NV, TandM Solutions and Tokalabs.

5G Verticals INNOvation Infrastructure (5G-VINNI), a 5GPPP H2020-ICT project, is a European funded initiative with over 20 major industry participants. Its aim is to accelerate the uptake of 5G in Europe by providing an end-to-end (E2E) facility that validates the performance of new 5G technologies by operating trials of advanced vertical sector services.

Based in Poperinge, Belgium, Page Electronica NV assembles and retails technological products and offers the latest in electronics manufacturing services (EMS) and testing techniques.

TandM Solutions is a test development specialist in radio frequency (RF) design validation and compliance test systems, based in Fleet, UK.

Tokalabs is a provider of software defined solutions offering a simple, push-button approach to automating and sandboxing hybrid network resources and labs, and is based in San Jose in the US.

The programme will initially focus on driving innovation in the following verticals: electric vehicles and components, batteries and management, charging infrastructure, connected mobility, voice recognition, AI and ML, navigation technologies, customer experiences, car buying experiences, and autonomous vehicles.

The programme will award grants ranging from ₹ 500,000 to ₹ 200,000. It will be open to both external developers – including students, innovators, inventors, startups and other tech companies – and internal employee teams at MG Motor and its programme partners.

Huawei unveils its own open source software ecosystem, announces Developer Program 2.0

Chinese technology giant Huawei, which is facing a possible US trade ban, unveiled its own open source software ecosystem on September 20, with the goal of attracting global developers and players to use its system.

At Huawei Connect 2019, the company also announced an investment of US\$ 1.5 billion in the next five years as part of its Developer Program 2.0.

Under this upgraded programme, Huawei will provide funding to universities, individuals, startups and enterprises to support them in learning, product development and marketing.

The firm aims to work with 1000 universities around the world to nurture five million developers in five years. The goal is to partner with

enterprises and individual developers to build the ecosystem of the computing industry, company sources said.

However, Patrick Zhang, CTO of Huawei cloud and AI products and services, acknowledged that it would be challenging, both on the technical and business levels, to get developers and firms to come on board Huawei's open source ecosystem.

Microsoft adds new programming patterns to .NET Core open source framework

Microsoft has released .NET Core 3.0, bringing new capabilities to the open source framework.

The updated .NET Core comes with desktop support for Windows Presentation Foundation (WPF) and Windows Forms, which enable user interfaces in the Windows operating system.

Another feature is support for self-contained applications, such that any .NET Core application can run from its own executable without the need for .NET to be separately installed. Also, the integrated C# version 8 programming language has gained new patterns that can expand developer productivity.

The updated C# 8.0 programming language in .NET Core 3.0 provides improved safety features, including the new nullable reference type in C# 8.0, added to make code safer.

Apart from the .NET Core update, Microsoft also released a new version of its flagship developer tool – Visual Studio 2019 version 16.3 – providing full support for .NET Core 3.0.

In a keynote address at the recent .NET Conf 2019 virtual developer event, Scott Hunter, director of programme management for .NET at Microsoft, said there are more than one million active .NET Core developers today.

